

STATE UNIVERSITY OF ZANZIBAR (SUZA)

School of Computing, Communication and Media Studies (SCCMS)

Department of Computer Science & Information Technology

Web Technologies

CONCEPT NOTE

PROJECT TITLE: University Innovation Connect (UIC): A Web-Based Collaborative Platform for Student Idea Sharing and Lecturer Feedback at SUZA

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Academic Year: 2025/2026

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Submission Date: June 2026

Document Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Description of Change
0.1	June 2026	Khadija Ali Said Rahma Suleiman Abdalla	Initial draft

1. Project Title

Working Title:

University Innovation Connect (UIC): A Collaborative Web Platform for Enhancing Student Innovation at the State University of Zanzibar (SUZA)

2. Background and Problem Statement

The State University of Zanzibar (SUZA) encourages students to develop innovative ideas and solutions through academic projects, coursework, and extracurricular activities. However, these ideas are commonly shared through informal channels such as classroom discussions, WhatsApp groups, and face-to-face communication. As a result, many valuable ideas are not properly documented, are difficult to access later, and receive limited collaboration and feedback from lecturers and fellow students.

Currently, SUZA does not have a centralized web-based platform dedicated to collecting, managing, and promoting student innovation. This situation leads to the loss of potentially valuable ideas, limited interaction between students and lecturers, insufficient feedback on innovative projects, and repetition of similar academic work. Therefore, there is a need for a simple and structured web-based system that enables students to share innovative ideas, collaborate with others, receive constructive feedback from lecturers, and maintain a repository of innovations for future reference.

3. Proposed Solution

The proposed solution is **University Innovation Connect (UIC)**, a web-based platform designed to support innovation and collaboration among students and lecturers at the State University of Zanzibar (SUZA). The system will provide a centralized environment where students can register, log in, post innovative ideas or solutions to identified problems, and interact with ideas shared by other users.

The platform will also enable lecturers to review submitted ideas, provide feedback and guidance, and encourage the development of promising innovations. In addition, users will be able to comment on ideas and vote for those they find useful, promoting collaboration and knowledge sharing. By providing a structured and accessible platform, the system will reduce the loss of innovative ideas, improve communication between students and lecturers, and foster a culture of innovation within the university.

4. Aim and Objectives

4.1 Aim

The aim of this project is to develop a web-based platform that enables students and lecturers at the State University of Zanzibar (SUZA) to share, discuss, and improve innovative ideas through a structured and collaborative environment.

4.2 Specific Objectives

- To design and develop a secure user registration and login system for students and lecturers.
- To develop a feature that enables students to post innovative ideas and solutions to identified problems.
- To implement a commenting and feedback mechanism that allows lecturers and students to review and improve submitted ideas.
- To develop a voting system that enables users to support and identify the most valuable innovations.

5. Scope

5.1 In Scope

The University Innovation Connect (UIC) system will include the following features:

- User registration and login for students and lecturers.
- User profile management.
- Posting innovative ideas and solutions by students.
- Viewing and searching for shared ideas.
- Commenting on ideas to encourage discussion and collaboration.
- Providing feedback and guidance by lecturers.
- Voting or liking ideas to identify popular and valuable innovations.
- Administrator management of users and system content.

5.2 Out of Scope

The following features are not included in this project:

- Mobile application development.
- Artificial Intelligence (AI)-based idea recommendations or analysis.
- Real-time chat or video conferencing.
- Online file sharing for large multimedia content.
- Integration with external university systems such as student registration or learning management systems.

6. Target Users and Beneficiaries

The University Innovation Connect (UIC) system is intended to serve the following users and beneficiaries:

- **Students** - Register and log in to the system, submit innovative ideas or solutions, view ideas shared by other students, comment on ideas, vote for innovative solutions, and receive feedback from lecturers.
- **Lecturers** - Review students' submitted ideas, provide comments and constructive feedback, guide students in improving their innovations, and monitor innovation activities.
- **System Administrator** - Manage user accounts, monitor system activities, moderate inappropriate content, and maintain the overall functionality and security of the system.

Beneficiaries

The project will benefit:

- **Students** by providing a centralized platform to share, improve, and showcase innovative ideas.
- **Lecturers** by making it easier to mentor, evaluate, and provide feedback on student innovations.
- **The State University of Zanzibar (SUZA)** by promoting collaboration, preserving innovative ideas, and fostering a culture of creativity and innovation within the university.

7. Proposed Tools and Technologies

Layer	Proposed Technology	Justification
Front-end	HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, React	To create a responsive, interactive, and user-friendly web interface for students and lecturers.
Back-end	Spring Boot (Java)	To develop secure, scalable, and maintainable RESTful APIs for handling system logic and user requests.
Database	PostgreSQL	To securely store user accounts, ideas, comments, votes, and other system data with high reliability.
Hosting / Other	GitHub, Git, Postman, REST API	GitHub and Git will be used for version control and collaboration, Postman for testing APIs, and REST API for communication between the front-end and back-end.

8. Expected Outcomes and Significance

The expected outcome of this project is a fully functional web-based system called **University Innovation Connect (UIC)** that enables students and lecturers at the State University of Zanzibar (SUZA) to share, manage, and develop innovative ideas in a structured environment.

The system will provide a centralized platform where students can submit ideas, receive feedback, and collaborate with others, while lecturers can review and guide innovation development. This will improve communication between students and lecturers, reduce the loss of valuable ideas, and encourage continuous academic innovation within the university.

In terms of significance, the project will contribute to improving the culture of innovation at SUZA by promoting structured idea sharing and collaboration. It will also serve as a practical demonstration of web technologies such as React, Spring Boot, and PostgreSQL, while enhancing the developer's skills in full-stack web development.

9. Preliminary Timeline

Phase	Activity	Approx. Duration
1	Requirements gathering & analysis	1 week
2	System design (SRS, SDD)	1 week
3	Implementation / coding	1 week
4	Testing & evaluation	1 week
5	Documentation & defence	1 week

10. Preliminary References

- [1] R. S. Pressman and B. R. Maxim, *Software Engineering: A Practitioner's Approach*, 8th ed., McGraw-Hill, 2019.
- [2] M. Fowler, *Patterns of Enterprise Application Architecture*, Addison-Wesley, 2002.
- [3] React Documentation, "React – A JavaScript library for building user interfaces," <https://react.dev/>
- [4] Spring Boot Documentation, "Spring Boot Reference Guide," <https://spring.io/projects/spring-boot>

AI Tools Used in This Submission

AI Tool / Service	Specifically used for	Section(s) affected
ChatGPT	Providing guidance on formatting, and academic writing style (including IEEE references)	Sections 1-10

Student Attestation

We confirm that the intellectual content of this document the analysis, design decisions, and judgments is our own work. I have declared all AI assistance above. I understand that I may be asked to explain and defend any part of this submission orally, and that being unable to do so may be treated as evidence of misconduct

Project Repository (Version Control)

Field	Value
Repository URL	https://github.com/KhadijaSaid07/University-Innovation-Connect
Date of first commit	June 2026
Approx. number of commits	...
Supervisor granted access?	Yes